DAVID J. NAJERA

ENTERPRISE TRANSFORMATION EXECUTIVE | STRATEGY & OPERATIONS | PEOPLE & ORGANIZATIONAL LEADERSHIP

Misawa, Japan | +81-80-5552-0928 | davidnajera73@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/david-j-najera

EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Enterprise transformation and operations executive with 29 years of global U.S. Air Force leadership across the Indo-Pacific, Europe, the Middle East, and the United States. Known for entering complex operating environments, identifying organizational friction, aligning leaders and resources around the highest-value problems, and building systems that improve execution. Trusted senior advisor on strategy, organizational design, workforce and talent management, cyber and information operations, crisis response, infrastructure, resource allocation, and multinational partnerships. Experience spans organizations and communities of up to 13,000 people and national-defense portfolios valued in the billions.

CORE EXECUTIVE CAPABILITIES

Enterprise Transformation • Strategy Execution • Executive Advisory • Organizational Design • Governance & Operating Models • Operational Excellence • Workforce Strategy • Talent Management & Succession • Leadership Development • Change Management • Program Leadership • Cybersecurity & Digital Transformation • Crisis & Continuity Management • Infrastructure & Resource Prioritization • Risk Management • Executive Communications • International Partnerships • Joint & Coalition Operations

SELECTED DIRECT LEADERSHIP IMPACT

- Built and institutionalized a wing-wide governance model that brought command teams and cross-service stakeholders into one decision framework, reducing organizational friction and accelerating strategic execution during a major fighter-wing transition.
- Led the cross-functional integration of 3,000 personnel for Operation EPIC FURY, synchronizing manpower, operations, logistics, infrastructure, and support requirements for the wing's first USCENTCOM combat deployment in 11 years while sustaining Indo-Pacific deterrence.
- Created a deliberate leadership system for 300 senior enlisted leaders, embedding talent management, succession planning, force development, and onboarding into the wing's operating rhythm to strengthen accountability and continuity.
- Rebalanced manpower, infrastructure, and quality-of-life priorities across an 11,000-person installation to enable F-35 integration and worldwide contingency requirements while protecting ongoing U.S.-Japan operations.
- Reworked the staffing and operating model for a 100-person cyber and space organization supporting $25B in national-defense assets, reducing staffing requirements 33% while maintaining full mission capability.
- Reprioritized installation support across a 13,000-person community and a $71M O&M/NAF/MWR budget, driving corrective action on infrastructure, contingency readiness, quality of life, and community programs while increasing MWR revenue $1.5M annually.
- Redesigned technology-enabled workflows across global organizations, with prior career records documenting 30-40% efficiency gains across 20 sites and $12M in annual savings from technology and vendor negotiations.
- Built workforce-development and accountability systems affecting approximately 10,000 personnel across East and Southwest Asia, linking leadership development, quality assurance, performance management, and readiness.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Command Chief / Senior Executive Advisor, 35th Fighter Wing

U.S. Air Force | *Misawa Air Base, Japan* | *2024-Present*

Principal advisor to the Wing Commander for a fighter wing of more than 6,000 personnel and an 11,000-person installation supporting F-16, F-35, and P-8 operations, six U.S. military branches, and bilateral Japanese partners.

- Identified fragmented decision-making across command teams and cross-service stakeholders and built a unified governance framework that created enduring communication channels, reduced organizational friction, and accelerated enterprise execution during one of the wing's most consequential transitions.
- Led wing-wide integration for Operation EPIC FURY, personally driving alignment of 3,000 personnel across operations, manpower, logistics, infrastructure, and support functions to execute the wing's first USCENTCOM combat deployment in 11 years while sustaining Indo-Pacific deterrence.
- Built a deliberate leadership framework for 300 senior enlisted leaders and institutionalized talent management, succession planning, force development, and onboarding processes that strengthened leadership continuity, accountability, and teamwork across the wing.
- Directed enterprise prioritization of manpower, infrastructure, and quality-of-life investments for 11,000 personnel, resolving competing requirements to enable F-35 integration and worldwide contingency operations without degrading existing missions.
- Drove bilateral resource coordination with Japanese partners and aligned requirements across six U.S. military branches, improving regional effectiveness and interoperability while preserving operational capacity.
- Convert readiness, workforce, infrastructure, morale, safety, and organizational-performance issues into executive decisions and cross-functional action, giving the Wing Commander a clearer enterprise view of risk, priorities, and tradeoffs.

Operations Director, Cyber & Talent Development

U.S. Air Force, 100th Communications Squadron | RAF Mildenhall, United Kingdom | 2023-2024

Senior operations and workforce leader for a 300-person cyber and information organization supporting approximately 3,900 personnel and geographically dispersed European operations.

- Reframed technical cyber and infrastructure issues into operational risk for senior leaders, giving executives a clearer basis to prioritize upgrades, resources, security measures, and mission tradeoffs.
- Directed modernization and operational validation of expeditionary communications capabilities across multiple European locations, aligning technical teams, investment priorities, and contingency requirements to strengthen deployable mission support.
- Integrated network defense, information assurance, technology procurement, vendor management, physical security, and workforce training into a common operating approach, improving leadership visibility of technical and organizational risk.
- Introduced data-informed performance and crisis-response practices that connected workforce capability with technical readiness and operational demand, strengthening resilience across a high-tempo multinational mission.
- Led and developed a 300-person cyber and information workforce, aligning individual development and organizational capability with airlift, cargo, contingency, and theater requirements.

Senior Enlisted Leader / Executive Operations Director (Deputy Mayor / Town Manager Equivalent)

U.S. Air Force, 51st Mission Support Group | Osan Air Base, Republic of Korea | 2021-2023

Senior advisor to a 2,700-person mission support group spanning five squadrons on a joint U.S.-Korean installation of 13,000 personnel. Oversaw enterprise support encompassing 1,100 facilities, three runways, 37 dormitories, a $127M war-reserve materiel stockpile, $18B in protected resources, and a $71M O&M/NAF/MWR budget while integrating infrastructure, emergency operations, public services, personnel support, and operational readiness.

- Created cross-functional alignment across 35 organizations by bringing infrastructure, workforce, emergency-management, public-service, and mission leaders into common prioritization processes for a 13,000-person community.
- Reprioritized a $24M infrastructure and program portfolio around the installation's highest-risk mission and quality-of-life gaps and drove the Dorm Divestment Initiative across 14 failing buildings to focus resources on deteriorating living conditions.

- Led emergency-action and continuity planning during installation-wide power disruptions, coordinating response across organizations to protect personnel, sustain operations, and drive longer-term infrastructure resilience measures.
- • Drove beddown and sustainment support for a 450-person joint exercise, championed noncombatant-evacuation readiness and four base-wide contingency exercises enabling 8,000 sorties, and synchronized support for three presidential directives delivering munitions to Ukraine.
- • Filled the Command Chief role for 45 days and drove 7th Air Force's first Agile Combat Employment combat disbursement, developing peninsula-wide logistics and cyber-agility procedures that demonstrated combat capability from two sites with zero mission degradation.
- • Mitigated seven unmanned-aircraft-system incursions by synchronizing four counter-drone defense capabilities with base-defense and command-and-control nodes, protecting $1.5B in assets and 13,000 personnel.
- • Reimagined quality-of-life programming by expanding partnerships and events with the installation and host-nation community, increasing MWR revenue by $1.5M annually and contributing to PACAF recognition as Best Large Force Support Squadron.
- • Identified noncombatant-evacuation accountability deficiencies, forged joint USFK accountability procedures, and secured $1M for a dining-facility renovation supporting 7,000 Airmen.
- Stepped into fighter-wing senior enlisted leadership during five wartime exercises and aligned support functions around a forward-deployed wing of approximately 5,600 personnel, enabling realistic combat operations under contingency conditions.
- Expanded the installation's leadership pipeline by mentoring Airman Leadership School students and designing/facilitating an eight-week officer/enlisted leadership pathway seminar for 98 Airmen.
- Rebuilt and sustained governmental, military, civic, and sister-city engagement during pandemic constraints, strengthening U.S.-Republic of Korea relationships and becoming the first enlisted member awarded Honorary Republic of Korea citizenship.
- Earned the #1 of 18 Chief Master Sergeant stratification and a 'Ready Now' assessment for Command Chief responsibility, providing independent senior-leader validation of enterprise impact across operations, people, resources, and community partnerships.

Chief Operations Superintendent, Mobility & Joint Operations Support

U.S. Air Force | Fort Bragg, North Carolina | 2020-2021

Senior leader integrating Air Force and Army organizations supporting global special-operations quick-reaction forces, air mobility, logistics, and rapid deployment.

- Closed coordination gaps between Air Force and Army support organizations by aligning readiness, aerial-port, transportation, freight, and personnel processes around global special-operations quick-reaction requirements.
- Directed deployment logistics for 2,500 personnel and 36 tons of mission-essential equipment, synchronizing transportation, freight, personnel, and operational timelines to meet compressed contingency requirements.
- Designed 24/7 shift, quarantine, and continuity-of-operations measures during COVID-19, allowing air-mobility cargo and personnel deployments to continue despite significant workforce restrictions.
- Standardized cross-service coordination among logistics, personnel, readiness, and operational-support teams, reducing organizational seams and preserving rapid-response capability during sustained uncertainty.

Chief, Space & Cyber Operations

U.S. Air Force | Vandenberg Air Force Base, California | 2017-2020

Senior operations leader responsible for cyber, space launch, workforce, and joint-service support across nationally significant launch, experimental, and defense missions.

- Reworked how a 100-person cyber and space workforce supported $25B in national-defense launch and experimental assets, aligning technical operations, personnel readiness, and mission support around the highest-risk mission requirements.
- Designed organizational and staffing changes supporting establishment of the U.S. Space Force, reducing staffing requirements 33% while maintaining full mission capability and uninterrupted support to high-demand space operations.

- Prioritized a $1.8M budget and joint-service personnel resources supporting approximately 2,500 personnel across geographically dispersed space-launch and operations locations, matching limited resources to mission demand.
- Built performance-monitoring, workforce-development, and crisis-response practices that gave leaders earlier visibility of capability gaps and strengthened continuity for high-demand, low-density cyber and space functions.
- Improved organizational integration by strengthening onboarding, orientation, and workforce-support programs serving thousands of personnel annually, accelerating new-member readiness in a technically complex mission.

First Sergeant / Senior Human Capital & Organizational Leadership Advisor

U.S. Air Force | Japan, Qatar and other global locations | 2011-2017 | 6.5 years

Served 6.5 years as a First Sergeant and senior advisor to commanders on workforce readiness, employee well-being, discipline, performance, professional development, recognition, organizational climate, and complex personnel issues across operational organizations in East and Southwest Asia.

- Advised commanders and senior leaders on workforce readiness, employee relations, discipline, performance, morale, and organizational climate, translating complex personnel issues into decisions and corrective actions that protected both people and mission requirements.
- Built and reinforced professional-development, mentoring, recognition, and accountability processes that strengthened leadership pipelines, employee growth, performance, and organizational discipline across diverse operational teams.
- Diagnosed workforce and performance problems using readiness, quality, conduct, and organizational-climate indicators; worked with leaders to address root causes through coaching, development, accountability, and targeted corrective action.
- Led personnel-readiness and contingency-response actions during deployments and high-risk operations, balancing individual and family needs, force protection, staffing, and mission continuity under constrained conditions.
- Resolved complex employee and family issues by coordinating commanders, helping agencies, medical, legal, housing, and community resources, while building cross-cultural relationships across Japanese, Qatari, Saudi, U.S., and partner organizations.

Information Management, Technology & Administrative Operations Leadership

U.S. Air Force | United States, United Kingdom, South Korea, Saudi Arabia and other global locations | 1997-2011

Progressed from front-line information management and customer support into supervisory, technology, knowledge-management, workflow-transformation, administrative-operations, and enterprise program leadership roles, including data and information lifecycle management, requirements analysis, collaboration, dashboards, and delivery of decision-quality information to senior leaders.

- Served as a data, information, and knowledge-management consultant to leaders, analyzing information requirements, designing workflow and collaboration approaches, and developing common operating pictures and dashboards to improve the delivery of decision-quality information across disparate organizations.
- Redesigned technology-enabled workflows and administrative processes across global organizations, with prior career records documenting 30-40% efficiency improvements across 20 sites by replacing fragmented manual processes with more standardized digital workflows.
- Negotiated technology and vendor requirements credited in prior resume records with $12M in annual savings, using requirements analysis and stakeholder alignment to reduce recurring cost while preserving operational capability.
- Implemented digital and paperless workflow systems that shortened administrative turnaround, improved access to information, and increased service reliability across geographically dispersed organizations.
- Strengthened information assurance, records management, executive support, and technology-enabled operations by standardizing processes and connecting administrative work to operational requirements.
- Built the process-improvement and technical foundation for later enterprise leadership by repeatedly identifying inefficient workflows, redesigning how work moved through organizations, and developing teams to sustain the changes.

SELECTED TRANSFORMATION PORTFOLIO

Enterprise Governance: Diagnosed fragmented decision-making and built cross-functional governance structures that connected executive teams, command teams, senior enlisted leaders, and service stakeholders around shared priorities and faster execution.

F-35 Integration: Resolved competing manpower, infrastructure, logistics, workforce, and quality-of-life requirements to posture Misawa for fifth-generation fighter integration while protecting existing fighter and bilateral operations.

Operation EPIC FURY: Personally drove enterprise synchronization of 3,000 personnel across functions and theaters, enabling a major combat deployment without sacrificing regional deterrence.

Space Force Organizational Design: Redesigned staffing and operating structures for an emerging service construct, reducing requirements 33% while preserving mission capability.

Cyber & Digital Modernization: Converted technical risk into executive decisions, directed expeditionary communications modernization, and redesigned digital workflows to improve resilience, efficiency, and operational support.

Municipal-Scale Operations: Reprioritized infrastructure and community-support resources, drove corrective action on failing facilities, and integrated emergency management and public services with mission requirements for a 13,000-person community.

Talent & Succession Strategy: Built leadership systems rather than stand-alone events, embedding mentoring, onboarding, succession planning, performance management, and professional development into organizational operating rhythms.

International Partnership: Used sustained governmental, civic, military, and partner engagement to remove coordination barriers, improve resource alignment, and strengthen U.S. relationships with host-nation and allied stakeholders.

EXECUTIVE COMMUNICATIONS & ADVISORY

- Turn complex workforce, cyber, infrastructure, readiness, and operational problems into executive-level choices, tradeoffs, and action plans rather than simply reporting status.
- Build alignment among leaders with competing priorities by framing problems around enterprise outcomes, resource constraints, risk, and measurable mission impact.
- Develop executive briefings, strategic plans, decision analyses, policy recommendations, and organizational-performance assessments for senior military and civilian leaders.
- Operate in high-discretion environments requiring rapid synthesis of incomplete information, cross-cultural judgment, and communication across technical and nontechnical audiences.

EDUCATION

- M.S., Business Management, Western Governors University, 2025
- B.S., General Studies, University of Management & Technology, 2015
- A.A.S., Human Resources Management, Community College of the Air Force, 2012
- A.A.S., Information Management, Community College of the Air Force, 2001

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Professional Management • CompTIA Security+ • CompTIA A+ • Chief Master Sergeant Leadership Course – National Security, Strategic Communication, Executive Leadership & Senior Organizational Management • Marine Advanced Course • DoD/DEOMI Mediation Certification • Cyberspace 300 – Strategic Cyber Operations & Joint Capability Integration • AFFOR Intermediate Staff Course – Operational Strategy, Joint Planning & Global Force Management • USAF First Sergeant Academy – Human Capital Management, Employee Relations & Organizational Readiness • Defense Security Assistance Management Course • Military Sherpa Coach • Grief Recovery Method Specialist

SELECTED RECOGNITION

- 2026: Assessed 'Ready Now' for Tier 2 Command Chief responsibility; senior review highlighted leadership during Operation EPIC FURY, F-35 integration, and enterprise transformation.

- 2023: Ranked #1 of 18 Chief Master Sergeants and assessed 'Ready Now' for Command Chief responsibility; selected Command CMSgt as the #1 future role.
- First enlisted member awarded Honorary Republic of Korea citizenship for strengthening U.S.-Korean governmental, military, civic, and community relationships.

GLOBAL & FUNCTIONAL EXPERIENCE

Japan • Republic of Korea • United Kingdom • Qatar • Saudi Arabia • United States • Indo-Pacific • Europe • Middle East | Fighter Aviation • Mobility • Special Operations Support • Space Launch • Cyber & Information Operations • Human Capital • Infrastructure • Emergency Management • Community Services • Logistics • Executive Governance • Multinational Defense Cooperation

MASTER RESUME PURPOSE

This comprehensive source resume is intentionally detailed. Each substantive accomplishment is written to emphasize David Najera's direct leadership intervention: the problem or opportunity he addressed, the action or system he personally led or changed, and the resulting organizational or mission impact. Targeted application resumes should select the most relevant evidence for the specific role.